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Quick singles



The most favourite roommate?

I think Smriti (Mandhana).

Smriti the roommate, or Smriti the batting partner?

Oh, that's tough. I think India needs us more as batting partners.

Jemi the guitarist, or Jemi the batter?

Batter.

Straight drive or cover drive?

I love the cover drive, with the satisfaction of a straight drive.

If you had to set a quirky fan challenge, what would it be?

Since Red Bull gives you wings, I would like to have a fielding challenge where the ball is really far away and you have to dive and catch it.

One Red Bull athlete you actually associate yourself most with?

Associate myself most with? There are a lot of crazy athletes. But I think all of them, to some extent. Each and every one. There is KL (Rahul), there is Ben Stokes, there is Shreyas Iyer. I think, maybe being a Mumbaikar, we have a lot of similar traits. I'll go with Shreyas.

On November 2, would you be happier with the Player of the Series trophy or the World Cup?

Easy question. The World Cup.

Hometown hero: Rodrigues savours the moment after India's eight-wicket win against Australia in a one-off Test at the Wankhede Stadium in Mumbai in 2023.

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come, even when things look bad. It always works out, and that has helped me a lot.

You've never struggled with fitness, but maintaining cricket-level fitness across 12 months is demanding. How has your training adapted to that?

I take fitness very seriously because there's always room to improve. For me, fitness is as important as batting. You can have all the skill, but without fitness and stamina, you won't last — especially in a 50-over game, which is long and taxing. My goal is to have the same energy and strength at the 300th ball as I did at the first, and that's what motivates me.

Working with Red Bull makes it even more exciting. They have an athlete's performance centre in Austria with world-class facilities —

half of which I don't even understand, but they're amazing. This partnership feels like more than just a signing; it's like working with family. They genuinely want to help me improve and reach my highest potential.

Do you think, over the past couple of years, your cricket has started to speak louder than the chatter about your social media posts?

I used to feel bad when people focused more on my social media, because I've always been lively and active there. But I didn't give it too much importance. I knew that if I worked hard and gave my 100%, that was enough. As long as my intent was right, the rest didn't matter. Even now, I'm not doing it to silence anyone — I'm doing it to help Team India win and to stay true to my intent in whatever I do.